First News

14 April 2026 Monday

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control.

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Global, Regional Markets

Wall Street rebounded Monday, closing 0.63% higher after a weak open as software stocks rallied and focus shifted to earnings season. Optimism lingered that US–Iran talks may continue despite stalled weekend negotiations, even as Trump confirmed a Strait of Hormuz blockade.

Israeli PM Benjamin Netanyahu says Israel supports US President Donald Trump's decision to impose a naval blockade on Iran, adding that his government is in "constant coordination" with Washington.

Gold edged lower on rising inflation concerns after US-Iran peace talks ended without a breakthrough, with Washington's planned blockade of the Strait of Hormuz intensifying fears of a global energy supply shock. Gold slid as much as 2.2% to below $4,650 before paring losses.

Oil surged back above $100 a barrel, while equities declined and bonds slipped after Donald Trump ordered a blockade of the Strait of Hormuz following a weekend deadlock in US-Iran peace talks.

Asian equities tracked losses across Asian markets after President Donald Trump ordered a blockade of the Strait of Hormuz, heightening tensions with Iran following the collapse of weekend peace talks. Oil prices advanced, lifting energy producer stocks.

ASEAN Foreign Ministers expressed "serious concern" over the escalation of conflict in the Middle East The ministers underscored the importance of diplomacy and dialogue as the primary means to resolve these differences and maintain regional stability.

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Asia-Pacific

	4/13/2026	4/14/2026	%Chg
Dow Jones	47,916	48,218	0.63%
S&P 500	6,816	6,886	1.03%
NASDAQ	22,902	23,183	1.23%
PCOMP	6,098	6,054	-0.72%
NKY	56,924	56,502	-0.74%
SHCOMP	3986	3988	0.05%
HSI	25,893	25,660	-0.90%
KOSPI	5858	5808	-0.85%
SENSEX	77,550	76,847	-0.91%
TWSE	35,417	35,457	0.11%
ASX200	8960	8926	-0.38%
BURSAKLCI	1691	1680	-0.65%
JCI	7458	7500	0.56%
STI	4989	4984	-0.10%
SET	989	989	0.00%
VNINDEX	1750	1758	0.46%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Commodities - Metals & Agriculture

	4/13/2026	4/14/2026	%Chg
WTI Crude	104.53	96.85	-7.35%
Brent Crude	102.78	99.36	-3.33%
Gold (Comex)	4702	4783	1.72%
Silver (Comex)	73.93	76.04	2.85%
Copper (Comex)	585.75	606.25	3.50%
Nickel	7.7239	7.9293	2.66%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.8%	76.5	76.5	0.00%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.5%	92.5	92.5	0.00%
Coal	134.9	135.45	0.41%
Corn	445.5	451	1.23%
Wheat	590.75	591.25	0.08%
Cocoa	3327	3365	1.14%
Sugar	13.89	13.88	-0.07%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Strategy

Philippines

Instead of stimulating the economy, central banks are currently raising interest rates to combat price spikes caused by conflict-driven energy shortages.

- **Next scheduled Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas decision is on April 23, 2026; current benchmark rate 4.25%**

PSEI Trading Closed

- PSEI falls 0.72% to close at 6,054.05 after an intraday drop exceeding 2.0%.
- Services rose 1.02%, led by ICT, up 1.94% to 734.00.
- Banks, property and mining/oil sectors led declines. Market breadth: 82 gains, 121 fell, 68 flat
- Trade Value at P7.5B

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Philippines

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control,

6098 8.30pts., 0.14%

Range 6,095.11-6,151.80

Breadth 82 (+) 121 (-) 69 (unch)

Block Php1,229mn **Volume** 789mn **Value** Php7.79bn

Share buyback MEG OPM AGI

52wk H: crec ipm sgp
52wk L: gsmi jfc sli urc

Overbought – rrhi spnec agi dhi
Oversold – stn abs gsmi atn jfc urc allhc

Active	Value
ICT	947
BDO	919
BPI	486
JFC	387
SM	348
CNPF	314
APX	255
ALI	239
PLUS	228

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Foreign Trade

NFB(S)	$3.607mn
Total Month FB/(FS)	-$99.713mn
YTD NFB	$80.712mn
FB	3,922,822,516.70
FS	3,921,309,034.81
NFB(S)	1,513,481.89
TOTAL	7,844,131,551.51

Foreign Funds Bought
bncom cbc ew mbt pnb secb acen alter ap pcor scc sgp ani emi fcg cic green aba aev cosco ltg ali creit mrc mreit rlc rock shng dito glo tel ceb ict mac plus web alldy apx px

Foreign Funds Sold
bdo bpi dhi pse acr mer mwc mynld shlph spc spnec cnpf dnl gsmi jfc keepr monde rfm urc mwide imi ac agi dmc gtcap jgs lpz sm smc areit egrn meg rcr smph vreit cnvrg bloom pgold rrhi wlcon at nikl ogp

Global Funds Net Buyers
Wednesday 4/8/26: ICT GLO SGP CREIT BDO MBT PNB APX PX SCC PLUS IMI AEV JGS DMC LTG AP PGOLD MONDE MAC

	4/10/...	4/13...	%Chg
10yr Bond			
PHL	6.545	6.602	0.87%
US	4.35	4.285	-1.49%
Currency Pair			
USD-JPY	159.27	159.62	0.64%
USD-PHP	59.989	60.16	0.06%
USD-CNY	6.8292	6.8308	0.24%
EUR-USD	1.1723	1.1705	-0.35%

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

DHI 8.25 SCC 29.95 DMC 10.00

- **Elected Chairman of Dominion Holdings Inc., further solidifying a strategic mining alliance with the Sy family**

VMC 1.94

- **VMC is significantly involved in the biofuel and renewable energy sectors in the Philippines.**
- VMC operates a distillery in Manapla, Negros, that converts molasses into bioethanol.
- The facility was upgraded to produce up to 50,000 liters per day

PAL 3.36 MAC 4.43 CEB 32.00

- Pacific expansion (Palau and Saipan resumption, 2x weekly via) positive for revenue fill
- Dubai &Doha cut until May 31, high jet fuel costs cap near-term upside.
- Net capacity impact is flat on ceasefire outcomes. Watch fuel cost trajectory

SMC 69.20

- **DPWH Awards ₱7.78-Billion Boracay Bridge Project to SMC Unit**
- The Department of Public Works and Highways has formally approved the award of the ₱7.78-billion Boracay bridge project to San Miguel Holdings Corp. (SMHC), SMC's infrastructure arm, after no competing bids were received against the original proponent's proposal. The 2.54-kilometer bridge system — including a 1.14-kilometer limited-access span linking Caticlan to Boracay Island — will incorporate public transport access, pedestrian and bike lanes, and utility conduits for power, water, and telecommunications.
- The award adds to SMC's expanding infrastructure pipeline alongside the ₱58.42-billion SLEX TR4, with DPWH Secretary Dizon confirming that Ramon Ang has committed to a partial TR4 opening by end-2026. The Caticlan airport is separately being upgraded by SMC's Trans Aire unit with Megawide Construction handling terminal construction. For SMC, this reinforces its positioning as the dominant private-sector infrastructure builder in the country, with the Boracay bridge expected to be a long-term toll and concession revenue stream.
- **Stance on SMC:** MONITOR — Infrastructure award flow supports long-term earnings visibility. Toll road and bridge concessions provide recurring peso-denominated cash flows that partially hedge macro volatility.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

CNPF 32.00

- **Full-Year 2025 Net Income Up 11% to ₱7.1 Billion on Cost Discipline**
- Century Pacific Food posted an 11% rise in 2025 net income to ₱7.1 billion as tighter operating expense management offset a 100-basis-point gross margin compression to 25.1%, driven by normalizing input costs from a favorable 2024 cycle.
- Consolidated revenues rose 10% to ₱83.3 billion, led by 13% branded segment growth across marine, meat, milk, and emerging product lines, while the company invested ₱4.1 billion in capacity expansion and renewable energy projects including solar and biomass.
- The export business was soft but partially recovered. Management flagged a "tight leash on spending" approach for 2026 as input cost pressures from the oil crisis and weaker peso begin to flow through. With branded volume growth intact and the company actively investing in RE-powered capacity, CNPF remains one of the more defensively positioned consumer names on the PSE.
- **Stance on CNPF:** ACCUMULATE — Earnings quality holds; disciplined cost management and branded dominance provide resilience in an inflationary environment. Monitor 2026 input cost trajectory.

AXLM 2.34

- **2025 Net Income Climbs 23% to ₱849.6M on Record ₱10.2B Revenue**
- Axelum Resources posted a 23.42% jump in 2025 net income to ₱849.59 million, with consolidated revenues surging 38.85% to a record ₱10.19 billion, driven by a 41% rise in export sales on new customer wins across North America, Europe, Australia, and Asia, and a 47% spike in domestic revenues on wider distribution and stronger online engagement.
- Pretax income rose 39% and EBITDA grew 30% to ₱1.4 billion. The results underscore Axelum's leverage to the global coconut products boom, which has been amplified by health and wellness trends driving demand for coconut water, coconut cream, and desiccated coconut. As a food exporter earning predominantly in foreign currency, Axelum also benefits structurally from a weaker peso. The near-term risk is input cost escalation from higher domestic diesel prices affecting copra transport and processing.
- **Stance on AXLM:** ACCUMULATE — Record earnings with strong revenue diversification; peso depreciation is a structural tailwind for export-oriented revenues. Watch diesel cost pass-through risk on margins.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

MRSGI 1.11

- F**ull-Year 2025 Net Income Up 12% to ₱682.6M; Sales Breach ₱40B Target**
- Metro Retail reported a 12% rise in 2025 net income with total sales of ₱41.56 billion — surpassing its ₱40 billion annual target — as 10 new store openings across Luzon and Visayas drove topline growth; blended gross margin improved to 21.8% from 21.4%, supported by stronger food retail performance, though same-store sales growth was a modest 0.6%.
- EBITDA rose 12.4% to ₱2.63 billion. Operating expenses climbed 9.3% due to new store costs, higher utilities, and calamity-related losses — a pressure that will likely persist into 2026 given elevated electricity rates. MRSGI's Visayas and Mindanao footprint gives it exposure to regions less severely impacted by Metro Manila-centric cost shocks. The soft same-store sales figure warrants watching as consumer purchasing power comes under pressure from fuel and power cost passthrough.
- **Stance on MRSGI:** MONITOR — Solid expansion execution but muted same-store growth and rising utility costs are near-term headwinds. Defensive consumer staples exposure is a relative plus in the current environment.

IDC — Italpinas Development Corp.

- 2025 Net Income Falls 27% to ₱250.9M Despite 30% Revenue Jump
- Italpinas Development reported a 27.4% decline in 2025 net income to ₱250.9 million even as revenues surged 29.9% to ₱784.7 million, with the bottom-line drop driven by higher financing costs and lower gains from investment property reappraisals — non-operational factors that masked solid project sales momentum from Primavera City–Città Bella in Cagayan de Oro and Miramonti in Batangas.
- Subsidiaries IDC Homes and IDC Prime also began recognizing revenues during the year. The mismatch between strong topline growth and earnings contraction reflects the high-interest-rate environment's toll on leveraged real estate developers — a risk that may persist in 2026 given the BSP's pause on rate cuts amid oil shock inflation. Basic EPS fell to ₱0.35 from ₱0.54. The stock closed at ₱0.79 on Monday, near its 52-week low.
- **Stance on IDC:** AVOID near-term — Financing cost drag and appraisal gain normalization are structural earnings headwinds in a sticky-rate environment. Provincial real estate thesis is intact long term, but timing is difficult.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

CPG 0.67

- **Board Approves Internal Mergers; Phirst Park to Be Absorbed into CPG**
- Century Properties Group's board approved two intra-group mergers: the absorption of Phirst Park Homes into CPG as the surviving entity, and the consolidation of Century Communities Corp. into Century Limitless Corp.; the moves are intended to improve resource allocation, strengthen financial management, and enhance tax and regulatory efficiency.
- The mergers remain subject to shareholder approval at the upcoming Annual Stockholders' Meeting and clearances from creditors and regulators. Phirst Park is one of CPG's most active units, focused on affordable horizontal housing in Luzon — a segment with structural demand tailwinds from urbanizing provincial middle-income buyers. Consolidating it directly into the listed parent simplifies the corporate structure and could improve CPG's debt management profile. The restructuring is a positive governance signal but near-term EPS impact is neutral to marginally accretive pending completion.
- **Stance on CPG:** MONITOR — Structural simplification is positive; watch for shareholder and regulator sign-off timeline. Affordable housing demand is resilient but CPG's leverage profile warrants vigilance in a high-rate environment.

LTG 14.74

- **ET PI — Eton Properties Philippines, Inc. (LTG subsidiary, unlisted)**
- **Eton Centralizes Customer Experience, Tightens Delivery Standards**
- Eton Properties marked its 19th anniversary by launching a formal customer experience framework under the theme "Eton in Motion," organized around brand consistency, daily CX behavior accountability, and responsible operations — supported by a new Customer Experience Committee that measures satisfaction data centrally and governs delivery standards across all touchpoints.
- The initiative also includes an updated digital platform at eton.com.ph and an internal CX Operating Handbook setting governance standards for all customer-facing teams. As a subsidiary of LT Group (LTG), Eton's operational improvements are most relevant to LTG investors as a signal of improved real estate earnings quality. The CX initiative addresses long-standing developer reputation risks around unit delivery delays — a sector-wide pain point that has affected buyer confidence. Further portfolio and project milestones are expected through Q2 2026.
- **Stance on LTG (via Eton exposure):** MONITOR — Eton's operational overhaul is a constructive governance step. LTG's diversified conglomerate profile offers some buffer to property-specific risks; watch for tangible delivery metrics in subsequent quarters.

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	4/10/2026	4/13/2026	%Chg
AC	543	544	0.18%
ACEN	2.97	3.03	2.02%
AEV	29.8	31	4.03%
ALI	18.08	18.06	-0.11%
AREIT	39.95	39.5	-1.13%
BDO	122.8	117	-4.72%
BPI	101.4	99	-2.37%
CBC	62.9	62	-1.43%
CNPF	32.2	32	-0.62%
CNVRG	12.5	12.38	-0.96%
DMC	10.22	10	-2.15%
EMI	15.44	15.38	-0.39%
GLO	1,650.00	1,630.00	-1.21%
GTCAP	513	510	-0.58%
ICT	720	734	1.94%
JFC	169.5	161.9	-4.48%
JGS	28.7	27.2	-5.23%

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	4/10/2026	4/13/2026	%Chg
LTG	14.82	14.74	-0.54%
MBT	67.3	67.3	0.00%
MER	608.5	608	-0.08%
MONDE	6.67	6.54	-1.95%
PGOLD	41.7	41.5	-0.48%
PLUS	16.8	16.7	-0.60%
RCR	6.9	6.9	0.00%
SCC	30.05	29.95	-0.33%
SM	621	621	0.00%
SMC	69.3	69.2	-0.14%
SMPH	20.4	19.8	-2.94%
TEL	1,300.00	1,284.00	-1.23%
URC	62	60	-3.23%

TRENDING STOCKS

DIVIDEND YIELD INDEX (PSE DivY)

	4/10/2026	4/13/2026	%Chg
AREIT	39.95	39.5	-1.13%
CBC	62.9	62	-1.43%
CREIT	3.52	3.55	0.85%
DMC	10.22	10	-2.15%
DNL	3.81	3.7	-2.89%
GLO	1,650.00	1,630.00	-1.21%
LTG	14.82	14.74	-0.54%
MBT	67.3	67.3	0.00%
MER	608.5	608	-0.08%
MREIT	13.76	13.78	0.15%
NIKL	4.72	4.8	1.69%
OGP	34.85	34	-2.44%
PGOLD	41.7	41.5	-0.48%
RCR	6.9	6.9	0.00%
RLC	17.88	17.2	-3.80%
RRHI	46.1	46.4	0.65%
SCC	30.05	29.95	-0.33%
SGP	22.85	23.05	0.88%
TEL	1,300.00	1,284.00	-1.23%
URC	62	60	-3.23%

TRENDING STOCKS

PSE MidCap

	4/10/2026	4/13/2026	%Chg
AGI	9.98	9.85	-1.30%
APX	18.4	18.3	-0.54%
AUB	42	42	0.00%
BLOOM	2.09	2.05	-1.91%
COSCO	7.1	7.1	0.00%
DNL	3.81	3.7	-2.89%
GSMI	270	267.2	-1.04%
KEEPR	2.23	2.2	-1.35%
MEG	2.07	2.04	-1.45%
MREIT	13.76	13.78	0.15%
MWC	42	43.3	3.10%
NIKL	4.72	4.8	1.69%
OGP	34.85	34	-2.44%
PNB	58.25	60.8	4.38%
RLC	17.88	17.2	-3.80%
RRHI	46.1	46.4	0.65%
SECB	68.05	68	-0.07%
SEVN	34	34	0.00%
SGP	22.85	23.05	0.88%
WLCON	6.56	6.4	-2.44%